

NTO Customer Service — Knowledge Base

Northern Trail Outfitters (NTO) — Customer Service Reference

Return and Refund Policy

Northern Trail Outfitters accepts returns on most items within 60 days of the original purchase date. To be eligible for a return, items must be unused, unwashed, and in their original condition with all tags attached. Items that show signs of use, damage, or modification are not eligible for return.

Footwear must be returned in the original box. Apparel must be free of odors, stains, and pet hair. Camping and climbing equipment, including tents, sleeping bags, ropes, and harnesses, must be returned in original packaging and must not have been used outdoors.

To initiate a return, customers can contact NTO customer support by chat, phone, or email. A return merchandise authorization (RMA) number will be provided, which must be included with the returned package. NTO does not cover the cost of return shipping unless the return is the result of an NTO error or a defective product.

Refunds are issued to the original payment method within 7 to 10 business days of receiving the returned item. Exchanges can be processed for a different size or color of the same item, subject to availability. Gift card purchases are refunded as store credit only.

The following items are final sale and not eligible for return or exchange: customized or personalized products, digital downloads, gift cards, and any item marked as clearance or final sale at the time of purchase.

Shipping Policy

Northern Trail Outfitters ships to all 50 US states and to select international destinations. Shipping rates and delivery times vary based on the shipping method selected at checkout and the destination address.

Standard shipping within the contiguous United States typically takes 5 to 7 business days from the date of shipment. Expedited shipping takes 2 to 3 business days, and overnight shipping delivers the next business day for orders placed before 1 p.m. Pacific Time on weekdays. Orders placed on weekends or public holidays are processed the next business day.

Free standard shipping is available on all orders of \$75 or more before taxes and after any discounts are applied. Orders under \$75 are subject to a flat standard shipping fee of \$7.95. Expedited and overnight shipping rates are calculated at checkout based on package weight and destination.

Orders shipping to Alaska, Hawaii, and US territories do not qualify for free shipping and may have longer delivery windows than orders shipping to the contiguous United States. International shipping rates and delivery estimates are displayed at checkout. NTO is not responsible for customs fees, duties, or import taxes, which are the responsibility of the recipient.

Once an order ships, customers receive a shipping confirmation email with a tracking number. Orders can also be tracked from the Order Status page on the NTO website using the order number and the email address associated with the account.

Order Status and Tracking

Every NTO order is assigned a unique order number at the time of purchase. The order number appears in the order confirmation email sent to the email address provided at checkout and is also available in the customer's account order history on the NTO website.

Order statuses update automatically as the order moves through the fulfillment process. The most common statuses are as follows. Order Received means the order has been placed and payment has been confirmed. Processing means the order is being picked and packed in the warehouse. Shipped means the order has left the warehouse and is on its way. Out for Delivery means the carrier has the package and it is scheduled for delivery today. Delivered means the carrier has confirmed delivery to the address on the order.

If an order shows a status of Processing for more than 2 business days, or if a Shipped order has not updated tracking activity for more than 3 business days, customers should contact NTO customer support for assistance.

To look up an order, customers need their order number. It appears in the order confirmation email, in the shipping confirmation email, and in the account order history page on the NTO website.

If a delivered order cannot be located, customers should first check with neighbors and in any secure locations near the delivery address, such as a porch, garage, or building mailroom. If the package still cannot be found, NTO customer support can open a missing package investigation with the carrier. Investigations typically take 3 to 5 business days to resolve.

Product Warranty

Northern Trail Outfitters stands behind the quality of its products. Most NTO-branded products are covered by a limited warranty against defects in materials and workmanship for one year from the date of original purchase. Some product categories carry extended warranty coverage as noted below.

NTO-branded tents and shelters are covered for two years from the date of original purchase. NTO-branded sleeping bags and insulated outerwear are covered for two years. NTO-branded footwear is covered for one year. Climbing and safety equipment, including harnesses, carabiners, and ropes, is covered for one year but must be retired and replaced immediately if the item has been subjected to a significant fall load, regardless of visible damage.

Warranty coverage applies to manufacturing defects only. It does not cover damage resulting from normal wear and tear, improper use or storage, unauthorized modifications, accidents, or failure to follow care instructions. Consumable components such as laces, buckles, and zipper pulls are covered for 90 days only.

To file a warranty claim, customers should contact NTO customer support with their order number or proof of purchase, a description of the defect, and photos of the affected item. NTO will review the claim and, if approved, will repair or replace the item at NTO's discretion. Warranty replacements are fulfilled with the same item if available, or with a comparable item of equal or greater value if the original item is no longer in stock.

Third-party brands sold on the NTO website are covered by the original manufacturer's warranty. Customers filing claims on third-party products should contact the manufacturer directly. NTO customer support can provide manufacturer contact information on request.

Product Care and Maintenance

Proper care extends the life of outdoor gear and ensures it performs as intended. The following care guidance applies to NTO-branded products across key categories.

Apparel and Base Layers. Machine wash in cold water on a gentle cycle. Use a mild detergent and avoid fabric softeners, bleach, and dryer sheets, which can damage technical fabrics and reduce moisture-wicking performance. Tumble dry on low heat or hang to dry. Do not iron directly on printed or embroidered areas.

Insulated Outerwear and Sleeping Bags. Machine wash on a gentle cycle with a down-specific or technical fabric detergent. Tumble dry on low heat with two or three clean tennis balls to restore loft. Ensure the item is completely dry before storing to prevent mold and

mildew. Store loosely — do not compress insulated items for extended periods, as compression degrades insulation over time.

Waterproof and Rain Gear. Machine wash on a gentle cycle with a technical fabric detergent. Do not use regular detergent, which can clog the DWR (durable water repellent) coating. After washing, tumble dry on low heat or use a warm iron on a low setting to reactivate the DWR coating. If water is no longer beading on the surface of the fabric, apply a spray-on DWR treatment and follow the product instructions.

Footwear. Remove insoles and laces before cleaning. Brush off loose dirt with a soft brush. Spot clean with mild soap and cold water. Do not machine wash or submerge footwear. Allow to air dry at room temperature — do not place near direct heat sources such as a campfire, radiator, or dryer, as heat can degrade adhesives and materials. Store with the insoles removed and laces loosened to allow airflow.

Tents and Shelters. Shake out debris and spot clean with a damp cloth and mild soap. Do not machine wash tent fabric. Allow all components to dry completely before packing — storing a damp tent causes mold and degrades coatings. Store loosely in a large mesh bag rather than compressed in the original stuff sack for long-term storage. Inspect poles, stakes, and guy lines after each use and replace any damaged components before the next trip.

Climbing and Safety Equipment. Inspect harnesses, ropes, and carabiners before and after every use. Retire any item that has been subjected to a significant fall load, shows signs of fraying, cracking, corrosion, or deformation, or is past its manufacturer-recommended retirement date. Hand wash with mild soap and warm water. Allow to air dry away from direct sunlight — UV exposure degrades nylon and polyester over time. Store away from chemicals, solvents, and sharp objects.

Contact and Support

NTO customer support is available to help with order questions, returns, product information, and warranty claims.

Live Chat. Available on the NTO website seven days a week from 6 a.m. to 10 p.m. Pacific Time. Chat is the fastest way to get help with order status and returns.

Phone. NTO customer support can be reached at 1-800-NTO-GEAR (1-800-686-4327). Phone support is available Monday through Friday from 7 a.m. to 7 p.m. Pacific Time and Saturday from 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. Pacific Time. NTO is closed on Sundays and major US public holidays.

Email. Customers can submit a support request through the Contact Us form on the NTO website. Email responses are typically sent within one business day. For time-sensitive issues

such as order errors or missing shipments, chat or phone is recommended.

Response Times. During peak seasons — including the spring gear sale in April, the summer camping season from June through August, and the holiday shopping period from November through December — response times may be longer than usual. NTO recommends using live chat for the fastest resolution during these periods.

Order Changes and Cancellations. NTO begins processing orders immediately after they are placed. Order changes and cancellations can be requested by contacting customer support, but NTO cannot guarantee that a change or cancellation will be completed before the order ships. Once an order has shipped, it cannot be cancelled. Customers who no longer want a shipped order should initiate a return after delivery.